
Do your arithmetic
Do some soul-searching
Do what you want

Part 2 expands on this formula. It tells how to make the formula come alive for you. It presents real-life case studies, tells how to save on taxes, looks at retiring with kids, and suggests a few lifestyle changes that can save hundreds of thousands of dollars. Someone once said it's not ideas that change things, but tactics. Part 2 of this book helps you come up with tactics that fit your style. All that's required on your part is a little imagination.

Later on, when you're 55 or 65, if you want to you can "unretire" and go back to work. We used to work and then retire. This book suggests you work, then retire, then consider going back to work. Under this plan you devote your middle years to yourself and your family. During those years your mental and physical powers reach their height. You can explore, grow, and invest your time in what's most important to you. You can enjoy your children while they're still at home. Later, after you've lived the best years for yourself, you can go back to work if you want to. The choice will be up to you.

Pro athletes never plan forty-year careers. Martina Navratilova, Fernando Valenzuela, and Magic Johnson know their playing years are numbered. My work life lasted twelve years. To me, twelve years seems the minimum for a solid, proper career. But for football players, twelve years is the brilliant career of a superstar. Bob Griese, Herschel Walker, and Walter Payton may play twelve years. But most athletes burn out before they ever hit their Thirties Crisis. They may continue to dream of a chance to play in a Super Bowl, haggle over one more contract, or enjoy another headline. But their bodies scream at them to quit.

A tackle graduates from Ohio State and gets a signing